

Speaking and Listening Folio

The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-Time

Mark Haddon

Name

Class

Teacher

Three sessions. Six tables. One prompt on each. Talk for five minutes, write for two, move on. By the end of a session you have talked about all six prompts with the same group, and by the end of the folio you have talked with three different groups.

1. **Session 1 • Personal response.** Responding to opinions and expressing feelings.
2. **Session 2 • I couldn't disagree more.** Presenting and justifying a point of view, and answering someone who sees it differently.
3. **Session 3 • Passage analysis panel.** Reading closely as a group, and speaking about how the writing works.

The rubric is on the next page. Your teacher listens at Table 1. Your own notes are the evidence for Listening.

Rubric · Speaking and Listening continuum

SUBSTRAND	5	6	7	8	9 YEAR 9	10	11
LISTENING	I can ask clarifying questions	I can describe the key ideas in spoken texts	I can use active listening skills	I can interpret implied meaning in spoken texts	I can listen critically to spoken texts constructed for different purposes		
INTERACTING	I can present and justify a point of view	I can change the way I speak depending on the social relationship	I can share my interpretations, ideas and opinions in a group discussion	I can use my voice and register appropriately in different contexts	I can change the use of my voice when presenting, discussing or persuading	I can use inclusive and encouraging language to facilitate positive conversations	
PRESENTING	I can plan, rehearse and present information	I can present information clearly to a small group	I can use body language and voice qualities to clarify meaning in a presentation	I can present information clearly to a class group	I can change my use of body language and voice qualities to suit different audiences and purposes	I can use voice and body language to enhance meaning and engage audiences across a range of different contexts	I can use voice and body language features to engage and position the audience

Listening

Your written notes after each rotation: what your table said, in your words.

Interacting

What the teacher hears at Table 1, and what your table writes about you.

Presenting

Session 2 (reading the statement aloud) and Session 3 (the panel share-back).

Teacher observation · Table 1

SESSION	DATE	LISTENING	INTERACTING	PRESENTING	WHAT I HEARD
1 · Personal response					
2 · I couldn't disagree more					
3 · Passage analysis panel					

Levels are the continuum numbers above. Blank cells in the continuum are blank in the source document too.

How a session runs

- 1 You sit in a group of about four or five. Each group starts at a different table.
- 2 Every table has one prompt. Talk about it for 5 minutes. Everyone speaks, everyone responds to someone else.
- 3 When the timer goes, stop talking and write for 2 minutes: who said what, and what you think now.
- 4 Then the whole group moves to the next table. Six rotations gets you through all six prompts.
- 5 Table 1 is the teacher table. When your group is there, your teacher listens and records what you do against the continuum on the front page.

Sentence starters

The colours are the same on the WAGOLL wall. A good five minutes uses all four; a great one doesn't need the list.

Say how it hit you

- When I read this I felt ... because ...
- What struck me was ...
- It made me uncomfortable / curious / sad when ...
- My first reaction is ...

Respond to an opinion

- I agree with what ... said, and I'd add ...
- I see it differently, because ...
- I couldn't disagree more. ...
- I partly agree. The bit I'm not sure about is ...

Check you heard it right

- Do you mean ...?
- Can you say more about ...?
- So you're saying ...
- What in the text makes you think that?

Point at the words

- The word ... makes me think ...
- Look at the line where ...
- Haddon puts ... right next to ...
- It's the repetition of ... that ...

Bring people in

- What do you think, ...?
- We haven't heard from ...
- Let's go back to what ... said.
- Does anyone see it differently?

Session 1 · Personal response

Responding to opinions and expressing feelings

1. One person reads the quote aloud.
2. Go round once: everyone says how the quote made them feel and why.
3. Then respond to each other. Agree, disagree, add, ask.

Write for two minutes at every table

Who was at your table, what two people felt, and one thing someone said that changed or confirmed what you think.

Table 1 ★	I pulled the fork out of the dog and lifted him into my arms and hugged him. He was ... (Chapter 5)
Table 2	I find people confusing. This is for two main reasons. The first main reason is that ... (Chapter 5)
Table 3	Prime numbers are what is left when you have taken all the patterns away. I think prime ... (Chapter 19)
Table 4	I do not tell lies. Mother used to say that this was because I was a good person. But ... (Chapter 37)
Table 5	Mr Jeavons said that I liked maths because it was safe. He said I liked maths because ... (Chapter 61)
Table 6	I think it should be called a lie because a pig is not like a day and people do not ... (Chapter 29, on metaphors)

★ Teacher table. Your group's starting table and the order you move in are on the board.

I pulled the fork out of the dog and lifted him into my arms and hugged him. He was leaking blood from the fork holes. I like dogs. You always know what a dog is thinking. It has four moods. Happy, sad, cross and concentrating. Also, dogs are faithful and they do not tell lies because they cannot talk.

Chapter 5

- 1. How did this passage make you feel the first time you read it?
- 2. Christopher hugs the dog but describes the blood calmly. What does that do to you as a reader?
- 3. Do you agree that 'you always know what a dog is thinking'? Is that true of people?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	what changed or what got confirmed

I find people confusing. This is for two main reasons. The first main reason is that people do a lot of talking without using any words.

Chapter 5

- 1. When have you misread someone's face or tone? What happened?
- 2. Is Christopher right that people say a lot without words? Give an example from today.
- 3. Does this make you feel closer to Christopher, or further away?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	what changed or what got confirmed

Prime numbers are what is left when you have taken all the patterns away. I think prime numbers are like life. They are very logical but you could never work out the rules, even if you spent all your time thinking about them.

Chapter 19

- 1. Put Christopher's idea about life in your own words.
- 2. Do you agree that life is 'logical but you could never work out the rules'?
- 3. How does it feel to have a maths idea used to explain life?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	what changed or what got confirmed

I do not tell lies. Mother used to say that this was because I was a good person. But it is not because I am a good person. It is because I can't tell lies.

Chapter 37

- 1. Is never lying a strength or a problem? Say why.
- 2. Is there such a thing as a kind lie? Does Christopher think so?
- 3. How do you feel about Christopher correcting his own mother here?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	what changed or what got confirmed

Mr Jeavons said that I liked maths because it was safe. He said I liked maths because it meant solving problems, and these problems were difficult and interesting but there was always a straightforward answer at the end.

Chapter 61

- 1. Do you have a 'safe' thing the way Christopher has maths? What is it?
- 2. Mr Jeavons goes on to say life is not like maths because there are no straightforward answers. Do you agree?
- 3. Does it feel fair that an adult explains Christopher to himself like this?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	what changed or what got confirmed

I think it should be called a lie because a pig is not like a day and people do not have skeletons in their cupboards.

Chapter 29, on metaphors

- 1. What is Christopher's problem with metaphors? Is he being silly or logical?
- 2. Give a metaphor you use all the time. Would it confuse someone who takes words literally?
- 3. Does this passage make you laugh, or feel for him, or both?

DATE

WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID

who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW

what changed or what got confirmed

Session 2 · I couldn't disagree more

- Presenting and justifying a point of view, and answering someone who sees it differently
1. One person reads the statement aloud. That person is the Reader: they don't give their view first, they run the talk.
 2. Reader asks: 'Who agrees? Who couldn't disagree more?' Everyone takes a side and gives one reason from the book.
 3. Reader keeps it going: 'Does anyone want to answer that?' Change sides if someone convinces you, and say so.
 4. A different person is Reader at each table.

Write for two minutes at every table

The statement, which side you took, the best reason you heard from someone else, and whether anyone changed their mind.

Table 1 ★	Ed Boone is a good father.
Table 2	Christopher's mother had every right to leave.
Table 3	If everyone told the truth all the time, like Christopher, the world would be a better ...
Table 4	The adults in this novel have more 'behavioural problems' than Christopher does.
Table 5	Christopher's rules about red and yellow cars are no stranger than the superstitions ...
Table 6	Lying to protect someone is worse than telling them a painful truth.

★ Teacher table. Your group's starting table and the order you move in are on the board.

Ed Boone is a good father.

- 1. What has Father done for Christopher? What has he done to him?
- 2. Can someone be a good parent and still lie about something enormous?
- 3. What would Christopher say? Is he the right judge?

DATE WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW which side, and did anyone move

Christopher's mother had every right to leave.

- 1. What does Judy say in her letters about why she went?
- 2. Does having a hard time excuse leaving a child? Is that what happened?
- 3. Whose side does the novel take, if any?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	which side, and did anyone move

If everyone told the truth all the time, like Christopher, the world would be a better place.

- 1. Find a moment where Christopher's honesty helps, and one where it hurts.
- 2. Which lies in the novel do the most damage?
- 3. Would you last a day telling only the truth?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
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WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
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WHAT I THINK NOW	which side, and did anyone move
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The adults in this novel have more 'behavioural problems' than Christopher does.

- 1. Look at Christopher's list of his own behavioural problems. Now list the adults' behaviour.
- 2. Who decides what counts as a 'problem'? Who gets a label and who doesn't?
- 3. Is the statement fair, or just clever?

DATE WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW which side, and did anyone move

Christopher's rules about red and yellow cars are no stranger than the superstitions everyone else has.

- 1. What does Christopher say when Mr Jeavons calls the car rule illogical?
- 2. Name a rule or ritual people around you follow that makes no logical sense.
- 3. Is there a difference between a superstition and a coping strategy?

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
------	---------------------

WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
--------------------	----------------------------

WHAT I THINK NOW	which side, and did anyone move
------------------	---------------------------------

Lying to protect someone is worse than telling them a painful truth.

- 1. Who lies to protect someone in this novel? Does it protect them?
- 2. Is there a truth in the book that should have been kept from Christopher?
- 3. Does your answer change if the person is a child?

DATE WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW which side, and did anyone move

Session 3 · Passage analysis panel

Reading closely as a group, and speaking about how the writing works

1. Someone reads the passage aloud. Everyone follows in the book.
2. Work through the three panel questions together: What happens? How is it written? What does it show?
3. Everyone must point at a word or a line at least once. 'The bit where ...' counts. 'It's just good' doesn't.
4. Last minute: agree on the one thing about the writing your table would tell the class.

The three panel questions

1. What happens in the passage? Who is there, what is said, what does Christopher do?
2. How is it written? Sentence length, lists, numbers, repetition, dialogue, what is missing.
3. What does it show about Christopher, another character, or a big idea in the novel?

Write for two minutes at every table

The passage, the writing feature your table noticed, the words it lives in, and what it shows. Then the one thing you'd tell the class.

Table 1 ★	The opening: Christopher finds Wellington. (Chapter 2, from 'It was 7 minutes after midnight.')
Table 2	Christopher lists his Behavioural Problems. (Chapter 73, the list from A to R)
Table 3	Christopher reads his mother's letters. (Chapter 157)
Table 4	Father tells the truth about Wellington. (Chapter 167)
Table 5	'I see everything.' Christopher explains how he notices a field of cows. (Chapter 181)
Table 6	The station: signs, noise and detaching the mind. (London, around Chapters 193 to 197)

★ Teacher table. Your group's starting table and the order you move in are on the board.

The opening: Christopher finds Wellington.
Chapter 2, from 'It was 7 minutes after midnight.'

- 1. Count the sentences. What do you notice about their length and about the numbers?
- 2. Which feeling words are missing? What does that do to you?
- 3. What kind of narrator does this page promise?

DATE WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW the one thing we'd tell the class

Christopher lists his Behavioural Problems.

Chapter 73, the list from A to R

- 1. Why a list, and why letters? Who normally writes lists like this about people?
- 2. Which item surprised you? Which one is not really a 'problem'?
- 3. Whose words are these, Christopher's or the adults'?

DATE

WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID

who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW

the one thing we'd tell the class

Christopher reads his mother's letters.

Chapter 157

- 1. Two voices are on the page: Judy's letters and Christopher's narration. How are they different?
- 2. How does Haddon show shock without Christopher saying 'I was shocked'?
- 3. Find the moment you realised what the letters meant, before Christopher did.

DATE	WHO WAS AT MY TABLE
WHAT MY TABLE SAID	who said it, in your words
WHAT I THINK NOW	the one thing we'd tell the class

Father tells the truth about Wellington.

Chapter 167

- 1. Look at Father's sentences. What does he keep repeating, and why?
- 2. What does Christopher say? What does he do instead of speaking?
- 3. Who does the reader trust at the end of this chapter?

DATE

WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID

who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW

the one thing we'd tell the class

'I see everything.' Christopher explains how he notices a field of cows.

Chapter 181

- 1. Compare what Christopher sees with what he says other people see. How does the layout show the difference?
- 2. Is this passage a strength or a burden? Find the words that tell you.
- 3. How does this explain what happens to him at the station?

DATE WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW the one thing we'd tell the class

The station: signs, noise and detaching the mind.

London, around Chapters 193 to 197

1. How does Haddon put the noise and the signs onto the page? What does it feel like to read?
2. What does Christopher do to cope? Where does that idea come from?
3. What does this passage show about bravery?

DATE

WHO WAS AT MY TABLE

WHAT MY TABLE SAID

who said it, in your words

WHAT I THINK NOW

the one thing we'd tell the class

After Session 3 - Where is my evidence?

For each substrand, find the continuum line you can prove, and write the page in this booklet where the proof is. Your teacher's Table 1 notes are on page 2.

SUBSTRAND	LEVEL I'M CLAIMING	THE LINE, IN MY WORDS	WHERE THE PROOF IS
Listening			
Interacting			
Presenting			

Next time I'm at a table I will
